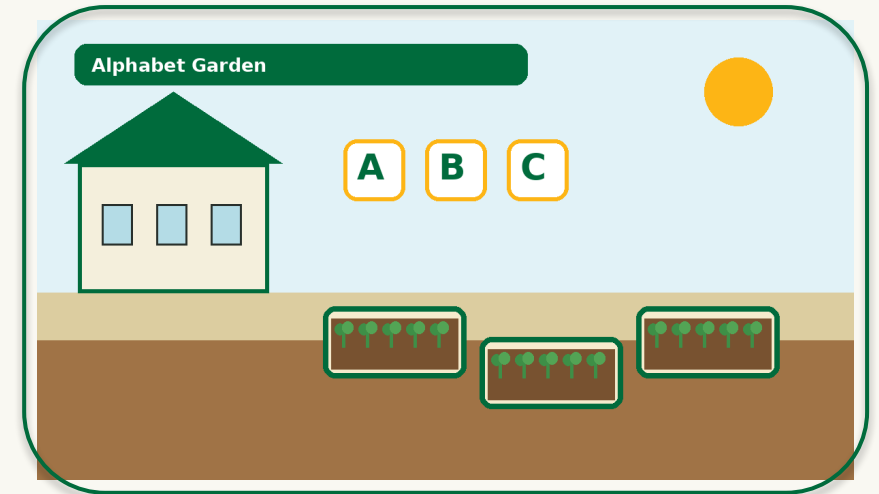


Alphabet Garden

Teaching Early Literacy Through the Garden

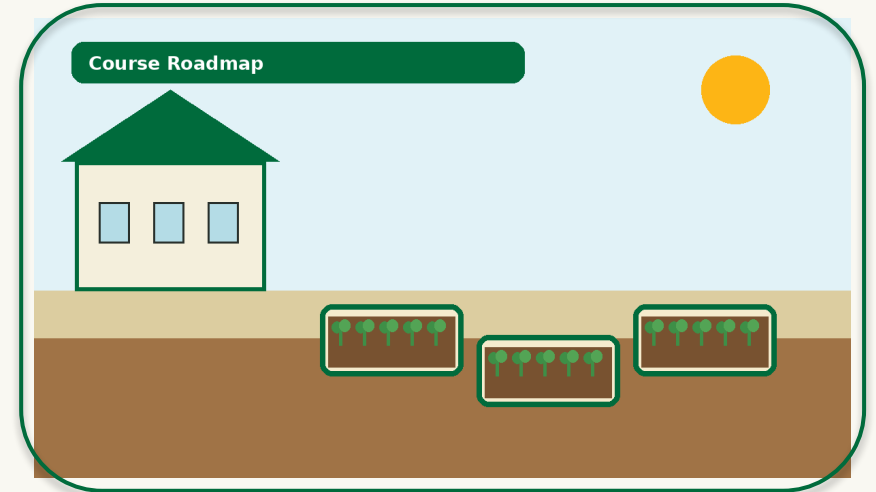
- LIFEWS AgriShine™ GrowMeal™ Teacher Training
- Audience: Nursery teachers and garden facilitators
- Format: Online micro-course + supervised garden practice
- Recommended duration: 2 hours 30 minutes online + 60 minutes practical



Course Roadmap

What teachers should be able to do

- Learning outcomes
- Explain the purpose and layout of an Alphabet Garden.
- Connect letters and beginning sounds with plants, foods, tools and garden objects.
- Use sensory exploration and play to strengthen vocabulary and oral language.
- Lead simple planting activities safely with young learners.
- Manage small groups outdoors and assess early-literacy learning through observation.



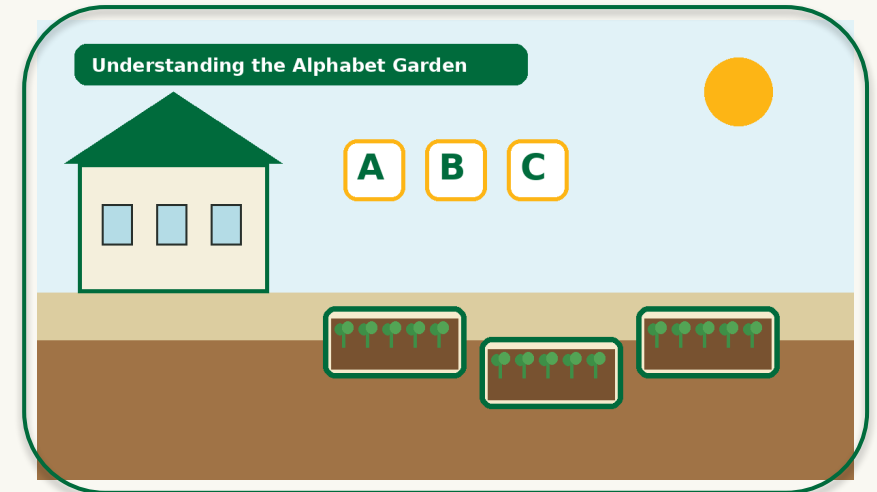
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Materials needed
- Alphabet cards A-Z; picture/word cards; child-safe trowels; watering cans; seeds/seedlings; labels/markers; baskets; clipboards; crayons; handwashing supplies; first-aid access.

Understanding the Alphabet Garden

The garden is a living literacy environment

- An Alphabet Garden intentionally connects letters with real objects, actions and experiences in the garden.
- Use what children can actually see: plants, foods, insects, tools, colors, textures and actions.
- The goal is not to force one plant for every letter. A letter may represent a crop, object, action or descriptive word.
- Teacher practice: point → name → repeat → sound → connect → use in a sentence.
- Keep labels large, simple and placed beside the real object.



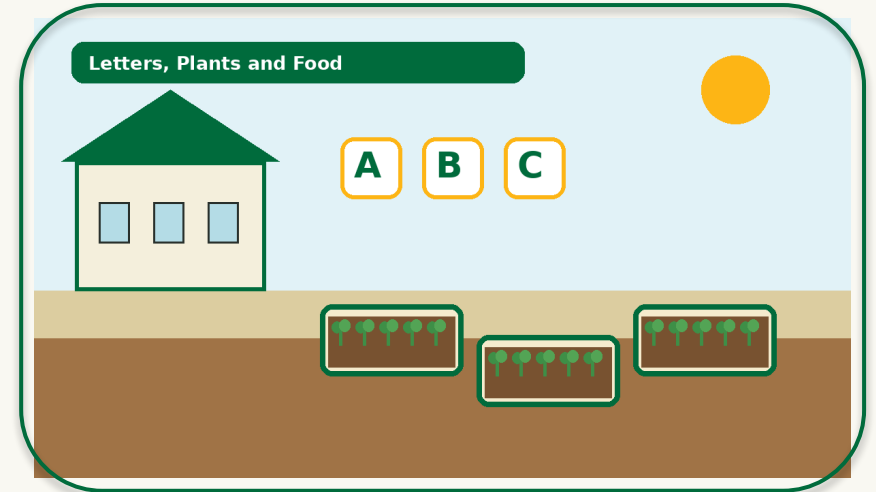
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Trainer prompt: What could A, B, C, S and W represent in your own school garden?

Letters, Plants and Food

Build sound-symbol connections with meaningful objects

- Start with familiar foods and garden objects before introducing unfamiliar vocabulary.
- Model the letter name and its common beginning sound: “B — /b/ — bean.”
- Let children see and handle the real object whenever safe.
- Repeat the word in context: “This is a bean. Bean begins with B. We planted beans.”
- Connect garden learning with classroom alphabet charts, storybooks, drawing and conversation.



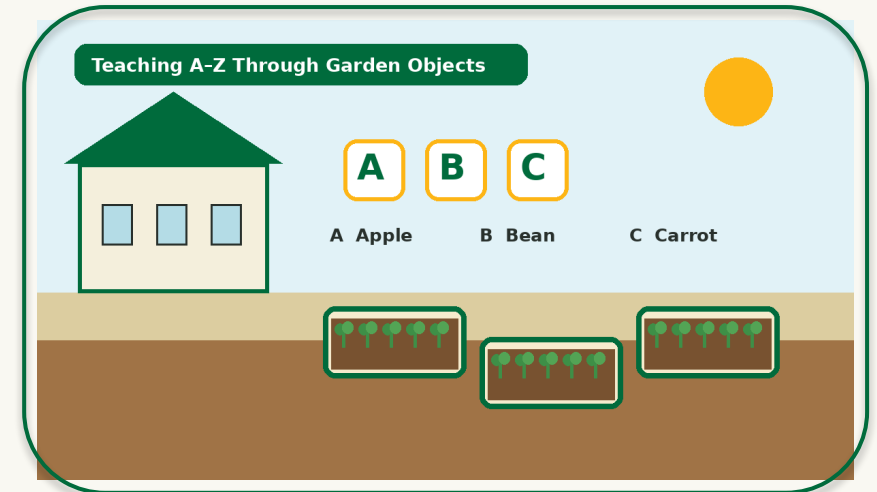
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Teacher check: avoid teaching inaccurate letter-sound examples simply to fill the alphabet.

Teaching A-Z Through Garden Objects

Use a flexible garden alphabet

- Possible categories: crops, fruits, herbs, tools, insects, soil words, actions and describing words.
- Examples: A-ant, B-bean, C-carrot, D-dig, E-earth, F-flower, G-garden, H-hoe, L-leaf, S-seed, W-water.
- For difficult letters, use a picture/object card or a locally meaningful word rather than an unsuitable crop.
- Run an “Alphabet Walk”: assign 3–5 target letters, search, name the object, repeat its sound and photograph/draw it.
- Create a class Garden Alphabet Book from children’s observations.



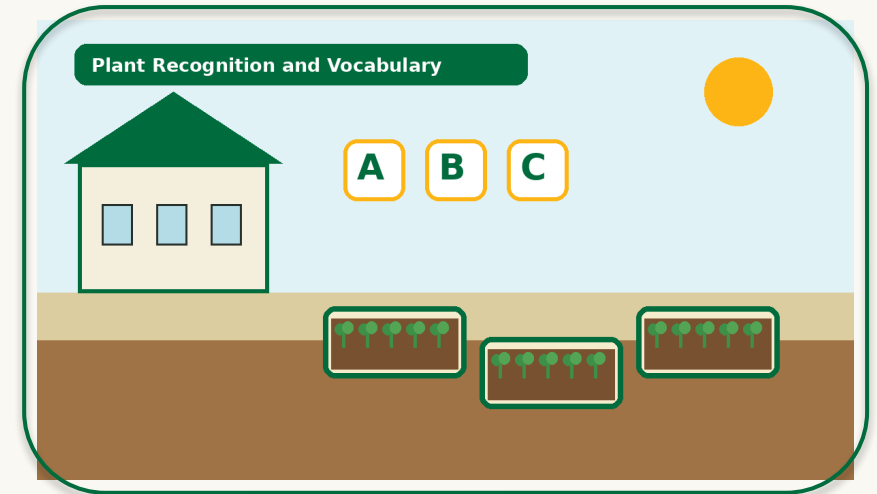
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Trainer task: prepare five locally appropriate letter-object pairs before the first garden lesson.

Plant Recognition and Vocabulary

Move from naming to describing

- Teach a small vocabulary set repeatedly rather than many words once.
- Core plant words: seed, root, stem, leaf, flower, fruit, soil, water, grow, harvest.
- Add describing words: green, soft, rough, smooth, wet, dry, tall, short, round, long.
- Ask open prompts: “What do you notice?” “How does it feel?” “What changed?”
- Revisit the same plants weekly so vocabulary becomes connected to growth and change.



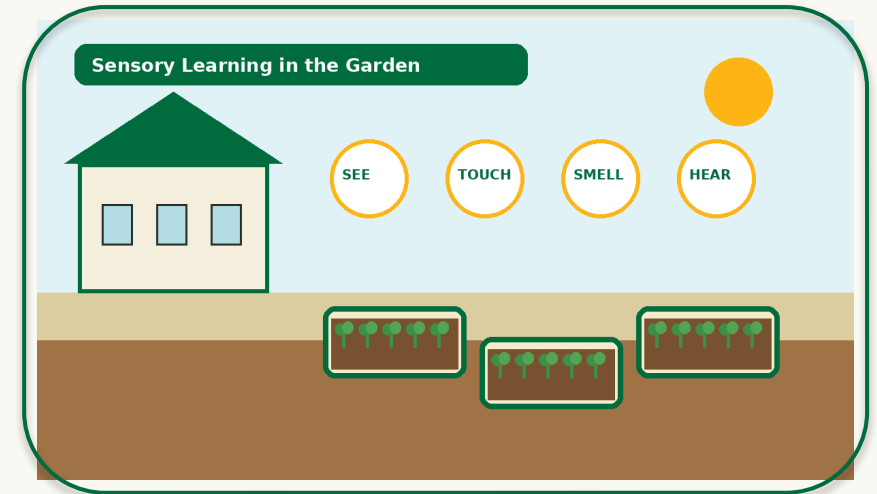
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Teacher routine: NAME IT → DESCRIBE IT → CONNECT IT → USE THE WORD AGAIN.

Sensory Learning in the Garden

See, touch, smell and listen—safely

- Sight: notice colors, shapes, letters and plant differences.
- Touch: compare safe leaves, soil and seeds; teach gentle handling.
- Smell: explore safe herbs and aromatic leaves without forcing participation.
- Sound: listen for wind, birds, water and insects; connect sounds to words.
- Taste: only as a planned food-learning activity using approved edible produce, hygiene procedures and school allergy rules.
- Always identify what children may and may not touch, smell or taste.



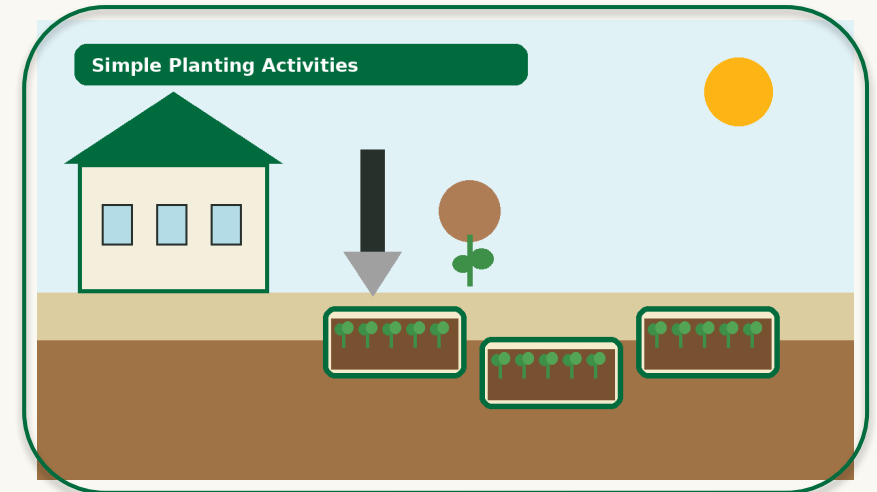
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Mini-activity: "Find something green, something smooth and something beginning with B."

Simple Planting Activities

Turn literacy into purposeful garden action

- Before planting: show the seed/seedling, name it, identify its first letter and review the steps.
- Demonstrate: make a small hole → place seed/seedling → cover gently → water lightly → add the correct label.
- Give children one clear job at a time and use child-safe tools.
- Repeat action words: dig, plant, cover, water, grow.
- After planting, ask children to say or draw what they planted and identify its beginning letter.
- Return regularly to observe change and reinforce the same vocabulary.



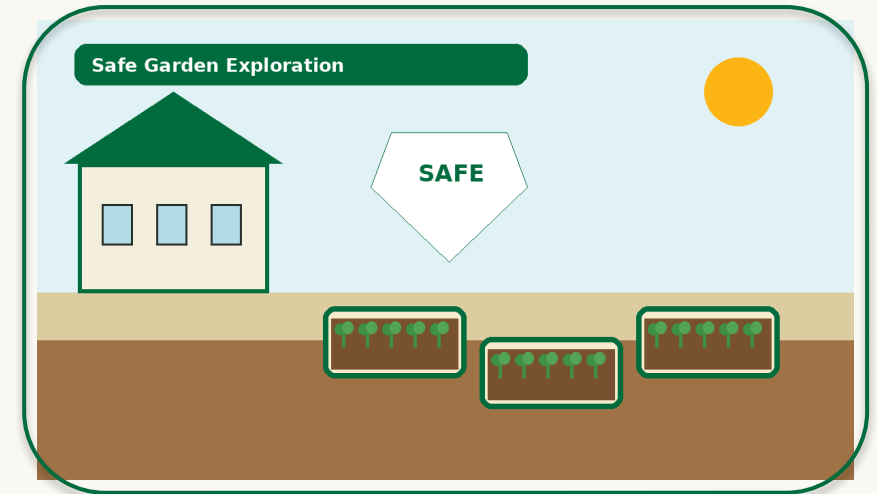
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Teacher preparation: pre-check bed, tools, water, labels and handwashing point before pupils arrive.

Safe Garden Exploration

Safety is taught before every outdoor activity

- Inspect the garden before the lesson: paths, tools, standing water, sharp objects, insects and damaged structures.
- Establish 4 simple rules: walk on paths; use tools only when instructed; ask before touching/tasting; wash hands after gardening.
- Use only age-appropriate tools and supervise water, compost and planting materials.
- Know school procedures for allergies, bites/stings, heat, weather and first aid.
- Stop the activity when conditions become unsafe.
- Teachers model safe behavior; rules should be demonstrated, not only spoken.



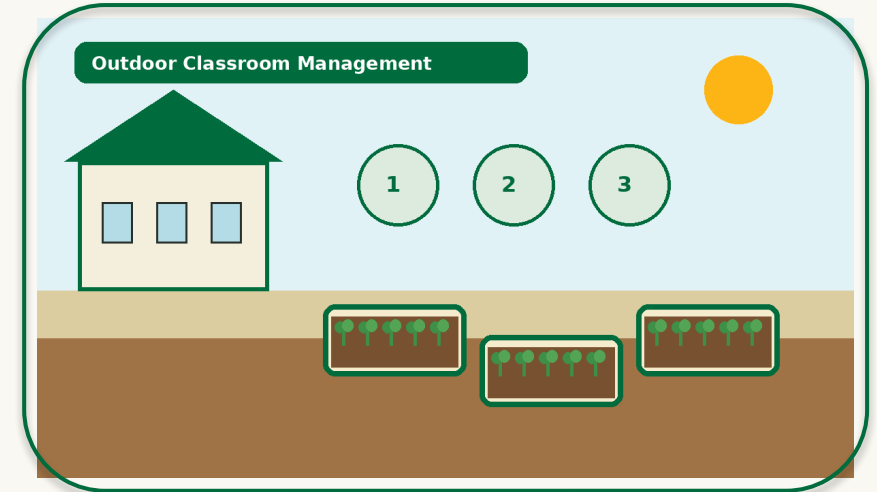
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Pre-garden check: PEOPLE • PLACE • TOOLS • WATER • WEATHER • HYGIENE.

Outdoor Classroom Management

Structure makes the garden teachable

- Use short sessions with a predictable routine: gather → demonstrate → rotate → reflect → wash hands.
- Teach in small groups; avoid having every child use tools at the same time.
- Create stations: letter hunt, plant observation, planting/watering and drawing.
- Define visible boundaries and a clear gathering point.
- Give each group a role: observer, letter finder, water helper, plant helper.
- Use a consistent attention signal and count tools before and after the lesson.



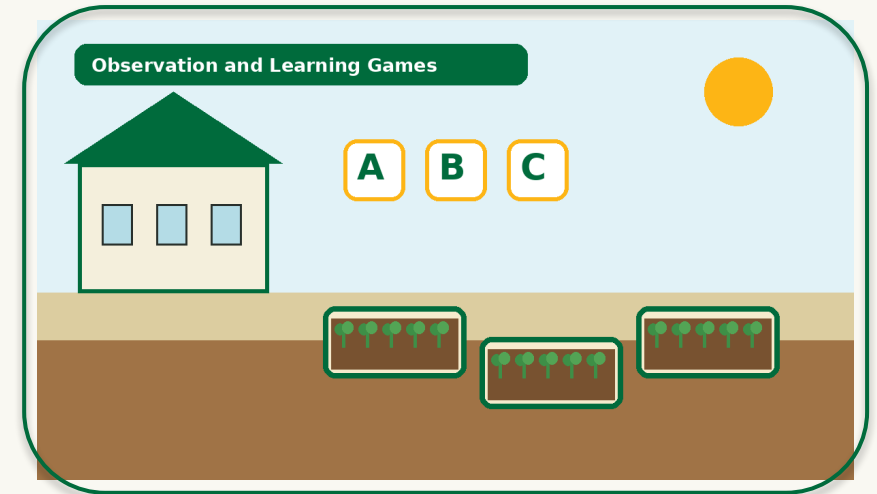
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Suggested Nursery garden lesson: 5 min welcome + 5 min demonstration + 15 min stations + 5 min reflection/hygiene.

Observation and Learning Games

Play should produce evidence of learning

- Alphabet Hunt — find a garden object linked to a target letter.
- Letter-Object Match — match an alphabet card to a real plant, tool or picture.
- I Spy — “I spy something that begins with L.”
- Mystery Basket — feel/look at a safe garden object, name it and identify its first sound.
- Garden Sound Sort — group picture cards by beginning sound.
- What Changed? — revisit a plant and describe new leaves, height, flowers or fruit.
- Garden Alphabet Book — children draw one observed object and the teacher records their words.



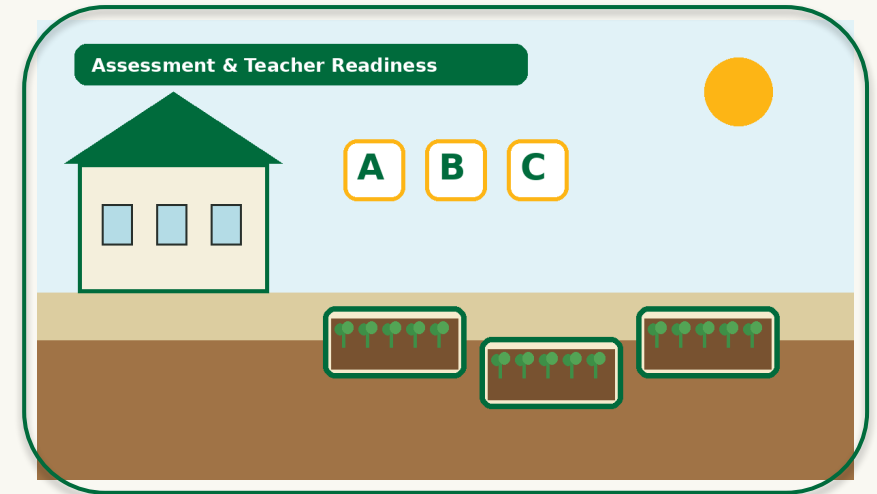
TEACHER PRACTICE

- Teacher role: prompt, listen, model language, repeat vocabulary and record what children can do independently.

Assessment & Teacher Readiness

Observe literacy in authentic garden activity

- Assess through brief observation rather than formal testing.
- Look for: recognizes selected letters; connects a letter with a garden word; names familiar plants/objects; uses new vocabulary; follows a simple oral instruction; describes an observation.
- Use three evidence sources: teacher checklist, child drawing/label, and short oral response.
- Do not expect mastery of A-Z in one garden session; track progress across repeated visits.
- Teacher readiness check: can you explain the garden, run a safe 30-minute session, model five letter-object connections, lead one planting task and record learning evidence?



TEACHER PRACTICE

- Completion task: design one 30-minute Alphabet Garden lesson for your class.
- Evidence base: garden alphabet lessons emphasize observation, alphabet-garden connections,

descriptive language and alphabet books, early learning programs

also use repeated vocabulary, shared reading and hands-on food/garden experiences.